

Quick Check

Lesson 1: Introduction to Taxonomy and Classification: Why Do Our Groupings Differ?

7 multiple-choice questions • choose A, B, C or D

Sub-Strand 1.1: Taxonomy I | Lesson 1

A farmer in Kericho, a fisher at Lake Victoria and a student in Nairobi each sort the same eight organisms: goat, chicken, maize plant, mushroom, algae, bacteria, bean plant and mosquito. Which prediction is most reasonable?

- A** Only the student in Nairobi can make correct groups
- B** They may make different groups, because each person may choose a different rule such as habitat, use or size
- C** They must make the same groups, because the organisms are the same
- D** They cannot make any groups, because the organisms are too different

**A group sorts the organisms with the rule: 'Can move from place to place on its own.'
Which set contains only organisms that clearly fit this rule?**

A Goat, maize plant, mushroom

B Mushroom, algae, bean plant

C Goat, chicken, mosquito

D Chicken, bean plant, mosquito

In a card-sorting activity, Group A put the mushroom with the plants and Group C put the mushroom in a different group. Both groups wrote a clear rule. What does this show?

- A** The mushroom cannot be classified at all
- B** The same organism can be placed in different groups when groups use different rules
- C** Group C cheated, because the mushroom can only go with plants
- D** Both groups must have misread the cards

Maize is called 'mahindi' in Kiswahili, and it has different names in Kikuyu, Luo and English. What problem can this cause?

- A** People using different names may not be sure they are talking about the same organism
- B** Only the Kiswahili name is allowed in science
- C** Names do not matter because everyone already uses the same groups
- D** Maize will grow differently in each community

One group sorted the eight organisms by usefulness: food, pests and disease-causing. Another learner says, 'That group is wrong.' Which response fits what the class found?

- A** The group is wrong, because organisms cannot be both useful and harmful
- B** The learner is right, because only habitat can be used to sort organisms
- C** The group is not wrong, because it followed a clear rule, but its rule is only one of many possible rules
- D** The learner is right, because usefulness is not a real feature

Which statement best describes what 'classification' means, as used in this lesson?

- A** Finding the most useful organism
- B** Grouping organisms using chosen criteria (rules)
- C** Collecting organisms from the environment
- D** Giving every organism a new name

At the end of Lesson 1, learners draw an initial model with a 'what we need' box. Which idea best fits what a shared system for classifying organisms should provide?

- A** Only people in Nairobi decide the groups
- B** Only organisms that are useful for food are included
- C** Each community keeps its own names and rules, and nobody changes them
- D** The same names and rules that people everywhere can use to identify and study organisms

All done

Ask your teacher how to submit your answers today (for example, on a paper answer slip).